AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS X EXAMINATION

MAY 2013

English Compulsory Paper II

Time: 2 hours 15 minutes Marks: 50

INSTRUCTIONS

Please read the following instructions carefully.

1. Check your name and school information. Sign if it is accurate.

I agree that this is my name and school. **Candidate's signature**

2. RUBRIC. There are THREE questions. Answer ALL questions. Question 2 offers TWO choices and Question 3 offers THREE choices. Attempt any ONE of the options in each.

3. When answering the questions:

   Read each question carefully.
   Use ONLY black ink.
   Do not use staples, paper clips, glue, correcting fluid or ink erasers.
   DO NOT write outside the answer box.
   Complete your answer in the allocated space only.

4. The marks for the questions are shown in brackets ( ).

Q.1. (Total 18 Marks)

Read the passage carefully and answer all the questions that follow:

In 1898, fourteen years before the Titanic sank, an American writer named Morgan Robertson wrote a book called 'The Wreck of the Titan.' In his story, the Titan, a passenger ship almost identical to the Titanic, and labelled 'unsinkable,' sails from England headed for New York. The story of the Titan predicted exactly what would happen to the Titanic fourteen years later. It was an eerie prophecy of terrible things to come.

In 1907, nearly ten years after 'The Wreck of the Titan' was written, two men began making plans to build a real titanic ship. At a London dinner party, as they relaxed over coffee and cigars, J. Bruce Ismay, president of the White Star Line of passenger ships, and Lord Pirrie, chairman of Harland and Wolff shipbuilders, discussed a plan to build three enormous ocean liners. Their goal was to give the White Star Line a competitive edge in the Atlantic passenger trade with several gigantic ships whose accommodations would be the last word in comfort and elegance.

The two men certainly dreamed on a grand scale. When these floating palaces were finally built, they were so much bigger than other ships that new docks had to be built on each side of the Atlantic to service them. Four years after that London dinner party, the first of these huge liners, the Olympic, safely completed her maiden voyage.

On May 31, 1911, the hull of the Titanic was launched at the Harland and Wolff shipyards in Belfast, Ireland, before a cheering crowd of 100,000. Bands played, and people came from miles around to see this great wonder of the sea. Twenty-two tons of soap, grease, and train oil were used to slide her into the water.

For the next ten months the Titanic was outfitted and carefully prepared down to the last detail. The final size and richness of this new ship was astounding. She was 882 feet long, almost the length of four city blocks. With nine decks, she was as high as an eleven-story building.

Among her gigantic features, she had four huge funnels, each one big enough to drive two trains through. During construction an astonishing three million rivets had been hammered into her hull. Her three enormous anchors weighed a total of thirty-one tons - the weight of twenty cars. And for her maiden voyage, she carried enough food to feed a small town for several months.

As her name boasted, the Titanic was indeed the biggest ship in the world. Nicknamed "the Millionaires' Special," she was also called "the Wonder Ship," "the Unsinkable Ship," and "the Last Word in Luxury" by newspapers around the world.

Source*: 'Exploring the Titanic'* by Robert D. Ballard

a. Explain in your own words the connection between ‘The Wreck of the Titan’ and the ‘Titanic’. (4 Marks)

b. What was the goal of the owner of the White Star Line in building Titanic? (2 Marks)

c. Describe the launch of Titanic into the sea. (4 Marks)

d. Why do you think Titanic was given so much importance? How was it different from other ships? (5 Marks)

e. Mention any TWO names given to Titanic. Why do you think those names were fit / unfit for the ship? (3 Marks)

Q.2. (Total 14 Marks)

Compose a response of about 120 words to any ONE of the options a or b.

EITHER

a. Your classmates have mixed opinions about reading fiction (novel / stories). Some of them think that reading (fiction) broadens mental capabilities and build language skills. While, others think that reading fiction is a waste of time; and the same time could be given to other activities. Your school authorities are planning to reallocate their budget and they need to know if more budgets should be allocated for the library based on students' interest.

Write a report for your school's management about this situation. Your report should include:

- subject of the report;
- sources of your information;
- your findings and suggestions.

OR

b. There is an advertisement in the newspaper of a student welfare centre near your home offering an exclusive scholarship for students. The criterion for the grant of scholarship is your writing skills.

Write a letter to the administration of the welfare centre outlining your intellectual / social / sports abilities and talents. Your letter should convince the authorities to grant you the scholarship.

Make your notes below. Write the final draft on pages 7 and 8.

Option _____

Q.3. (Total 18 Marks)

Write a composition of about 200 words on any ONE of the options a, b or c.
Remember to compose the final draft in complete sentences.

EITHER

a. In many schools, teachers are wary of their naughty students. Out of fear of retaliation, they fail to report problems or ignore them hoping that the responsible students will quit the bad behaviour by themselves. Explain what teachers can do to improve the overall behaviour of those naughty students. What should be done to make the school environment healthy for everyone?

OR

b. The first step in choosing a career path after school is to know yourself, your interests and preferences. Describe how you approach your upcoming life in college, the career path and subjects you want to pursue. Also elaborate on why you think you will be good at your chosen path.

OR

c. Due to lengthy courses, your school administration often accommodates your sports periods / time for studies of your course subjects. You really want to give some time to sports and extra-curricular activities. Describe why do you think it is important to allocate some time for sports and other activities besides studies. Give reasons for your answer.

Make your notes below. Write the final draft on pages 10 and 11.

Option _____

END OF PAPER

Please use this page for rough work